If your provider routinely waives your cost

If your provider routinely waives (does not require you to pay) your deductibles or coinsurance, the provider is misstating the fee and may be violating the law. In this case, when we calculate our share, we will reduce the provider's fee by the amount waived.

For example, if your physician ordinarily charges $100 for a service but routinely waives your 35% coinsurance, the actual charge is $65. We will pay $42.25 (65% of the actual charge of $65).

Waivers

In some instances, a provider may ask you to sign a "waiver" prior to receiving care. This waiver may state that you accept responsibility for the total charge for any care that is not covered by your health plan. If you sign such a waiver, whether or not you are responsible for the total charge depends on the contracts that the Plan has with its providers. If you are asked to sign this type of waiver, please be aware that if benefits are denied for the services, you could be legally liable for the related expenses. If you would like more information about waivers, please contact us at 800-821-6136 or write to G.E.H.A Enrollment, PO Box 21262, Eagan, MN 55121.

Differences between our allowance and the bill

Our "Plan allowance" is the amount we use to calculate our payment for covered services. Fee-for-service plans arrive at their allowances in different ways, so their allowances vary. For more information about how we determine our Plan allowance, see the definition of Plan allowance in Section 10.

Often, the provider's bill is more than a fee-for-service plan's allowance. Whether or not you have to pay the difference between our allowance and the bill will depend on the provider you use.

- **In-network providers** agree to limit what they will bill you. Because of that, when you use a preferred provider, your share of covered charges consists only of your deductible and coinsurance. Here is an example about coinsurance: You see an in-network physician who charges $150, but our allowance is $100. If you have met your deductible, you are only responsible for your coinsurance. That is, with HDHP, you pay 5% of our $100 allowance ($5). Because of the agreement, your in-network physician will not bill you for the $50 difference between our allowance and the bill.
- **Out-of-network providers**, on the other hand, have no agreement to limit what they will bill you. When you use an out-of-network provider, you will pay your deductible and coinsurance, plus any difference between our allowance and charges on the bill. Here is an example: You see an out-of-network physician who charges $150 and our allowance is again $100. Because you've met your deductible, you are responsible for your coinsurance, so with HDHP you pay 35% of our $100 allowance ($35). Plus, because there is no agreement between the out-of-network physician and us, the physician can bill you for the $50 difference between our allowance and the bill.

The following illustrates the examples of how much you have to pay out-of-pocket, under HDHP, for services from an in-network physician vs. an out-of-network physician. The table uses our example of a service for which the physician charges $150 and our allowance is $100. The example shows the amount you pay if you have met your calendar year deductible.

EXAMPLES:

In-network physician

Physician's charge: $150
Our allowance: We set it at: $100
We pay: 95% of our allowance: $95
You owe: 5% of our allowance: $5
+Difference up to charge: No: $0
TOTAL YOU PAY: $5